Account-based Service and Advocacy Offering Toolkit

UPDATED: NOVEMBER 2025

MERKLE

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YOUR 3-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B Transformation

WHAT IT IS

B2B sales transformation involves new processes, technology, data, and insights to allow sales teams to engage business customers more efficiently and effectively. Key capabilities are Sales, Service, Commerce, and Analytics and Reporting.

Key Stakeholders: CRO/VP Sales, CDO/CTO/VP Commerce, CIO

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- Reduced Cost to Serve
- Increased Customer Acquisition
- Increased AOV
- Increased Customer Retention Rates

See next pages for wedge and packaged engagement details for each highlighted module.

GTM HUB PAGE

This link has all the content to support the offering: training, engagement models, case studies, thought leadership, Merkle reports, etc.

SUB-OFFERINGS

- Account-Based Selling
- Account-based Service and Advocacy
- Marketplace Adoption and Acceleration

COMPLEMENTARY OFFERINGS

- Account-Based Marketing (ABM)
- Account-Based Experiences (ABX)

YOUR 3-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B Transformation: Wedges

WHAT IT IS

Enabling comprehensive organizational transformation through an Account-Based Everything mindset that reshapes how your business thinks, operates, and engages with customers.

We partner with leadership teams to fundamentally reshape business strategy, organizational structure, and cultural mindset—aligning every function around high-value account success. Our approach transforms how teams think, operate, and measure success by embedding account-centricity into the DNA of the organization.

These wedge offerings ”setup” the bigger account-based selling engagements and solutions.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- **Accelerated revenue growth through strategic alignment of critical business functions around target account success and expansion.**
- **Improved organizational agility from cross-functional teams unified by shared account objectives and customer outcomes.**
- **Enhanced competitive differentiation by delivering coordinated, best-in-class experiences that competitors cannot replicate.**
- **Sustained market leadership through a customer-first operating model that drives continuous innovation and long-term relationships.**

WEDGE

Can be delivered at **less than $100k** USD, to ‘open the door’.

North Star Digital Visioning	Agile Op Model Assessment	B2B Customer Experience Assessment	Tech & Data Modernization	Value Realization & Growth Optimization
$250-500K USD	**$150-300K**	**$250-750K**	**$250-500K**	**$150-500K**

YOUR 3-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B Transformation: Account-based Service and Advocacy

WHAT IT IS

A comprehensive post-sale customer success platform that transforms traditional service operations into strategic revenue-generating and customer advocacy engines through AI-powered automation and intelligent service orchestration.

Our Account-Based Service and Advocacy solution integrates intelligent case management, predictive service analytics, automated warranty processing, and field service optimization to create a unified customer success ecosystem. This approach transforms service interactions into opportunities for revenue growth, customer expansion, and brand advocacy while reducing operational costs and improving service delivery outcomes.

KEY BUSINESS OUTCOMES

Service-to-Revenue Transformation: Convert service interactions into revenue opportunities through intelligent upselling, cross-selling, and proactive customer expansion strategies that increase account value by 25-40%.

Operational Excellence: AI-driven case management, automated warranty processing, and optimized field service operations that reduce resolution time by 35% while improving first-call resolution rates.

Customer Advocacy and Retention: Proactive service delivery, personalized customer experiences, and intelligent churn prevention that increases customer lifetime value and Net Promoter Scores.

Strategic Account Growth: Data-driven insights and predictive analytics that enable account managers to identify expansion opportunities and strengthen customer relationships across the entire service journey.

ENGAGEMENTS

Are **over $100k** USD that you can sell individually or together.

AI-Driven Service	Asset Management and Warranty	Service Modernization	Field Service
$150-500K USD	$200-600K USD	$300-700K USD	$250-700K USD

PART 1: EXTERNAL

POV and Narrative

LINK

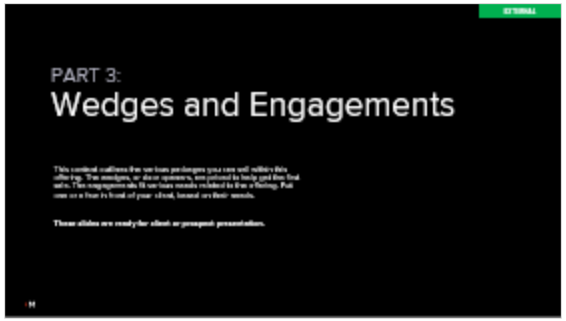
PART 2: EXTERNAL

Case Studies and Why Merkle

LINK

PART 3: EXTERNAL

Wedges and Engagements



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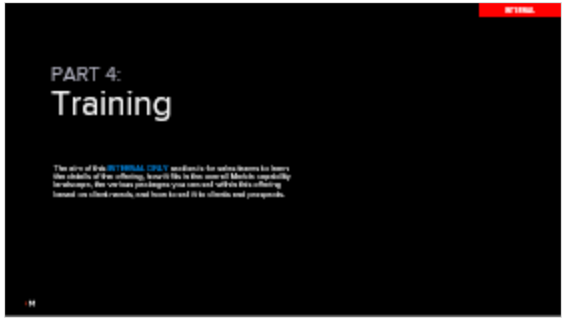
PART 4: INTERNAL

Learn the Offering



LINK

PART 1:
POV and Narrative

These slides include content that supports the offering narrative. It includes problem space definition, predictions or expectations on how the market will develop, supporting market research, the opportunity space, and our unique POV or approach to solving the problem.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

The most successful businesses have always known **how to ride waves**.

But now, the waves are crashing down on B2B customers.

Profitability Pressure

AI Uncertainty

Workforce Fatigue

Geopolitical Instability

7-16%
Account-based pricing premium

1.7x
Increase in B2B account retention

54%
lower rate of burnout among employees

52%
anticipate tariffs will amplify economic contraction

Sources: PwC, Adobe/CMO.com, FloQast, dentsu

The stakes have never been higher.

B2B has never been more competitive

+62%

increase in brands considered for the average B2B purchase

Deal cycles have never been more complex

+4.5

Increase in weeks of the average B2B purchase lifecycle since 2022, to 379 days

Sources: Merkle B2B Superpowers

And the job has never been harder.

B2B buyers don't feel heard or well understood

71%

of B2B buyers say they want suppliers to spend more time understanding and solving their **day-to-day problems**

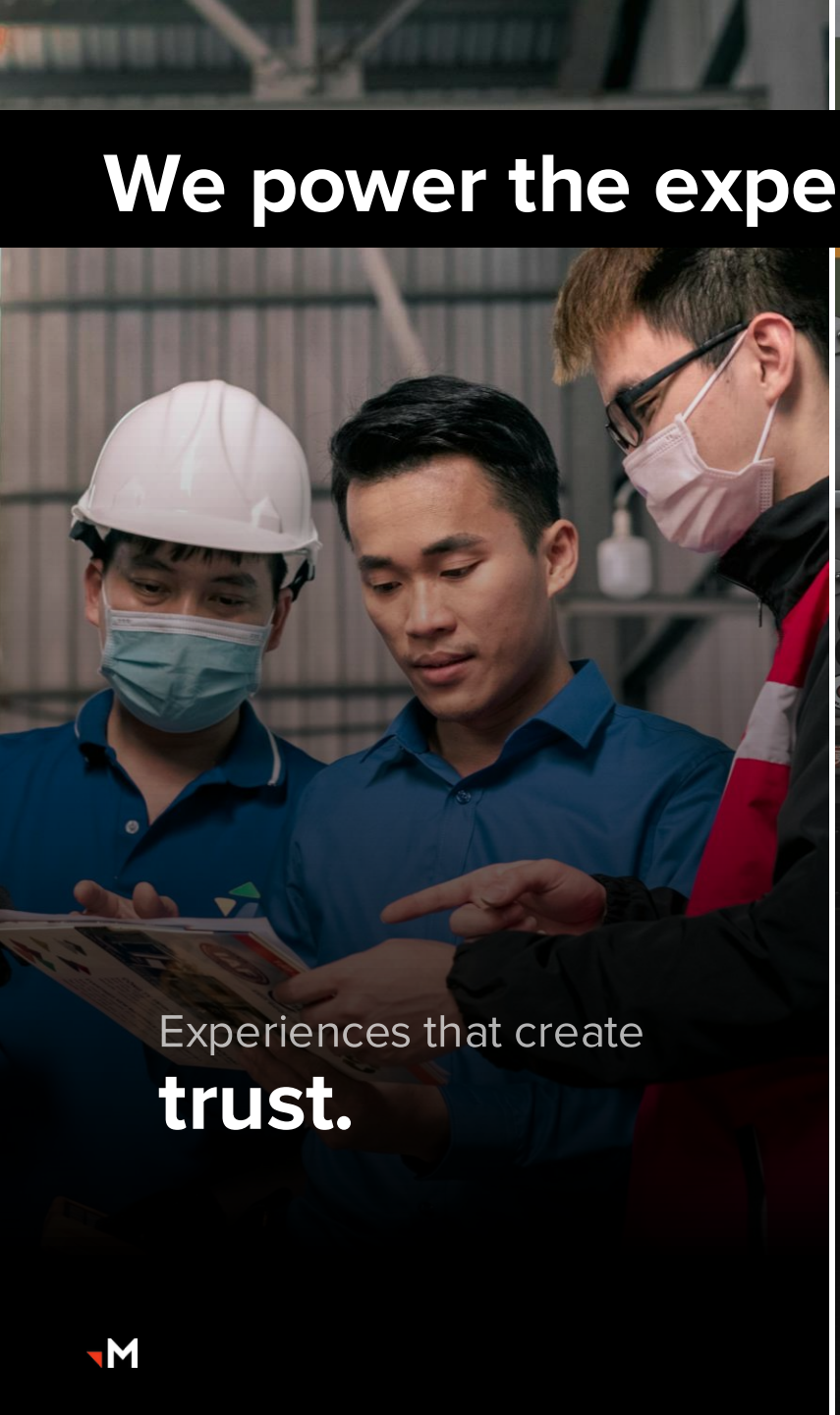
Buyers are more frustrated than ever

52%

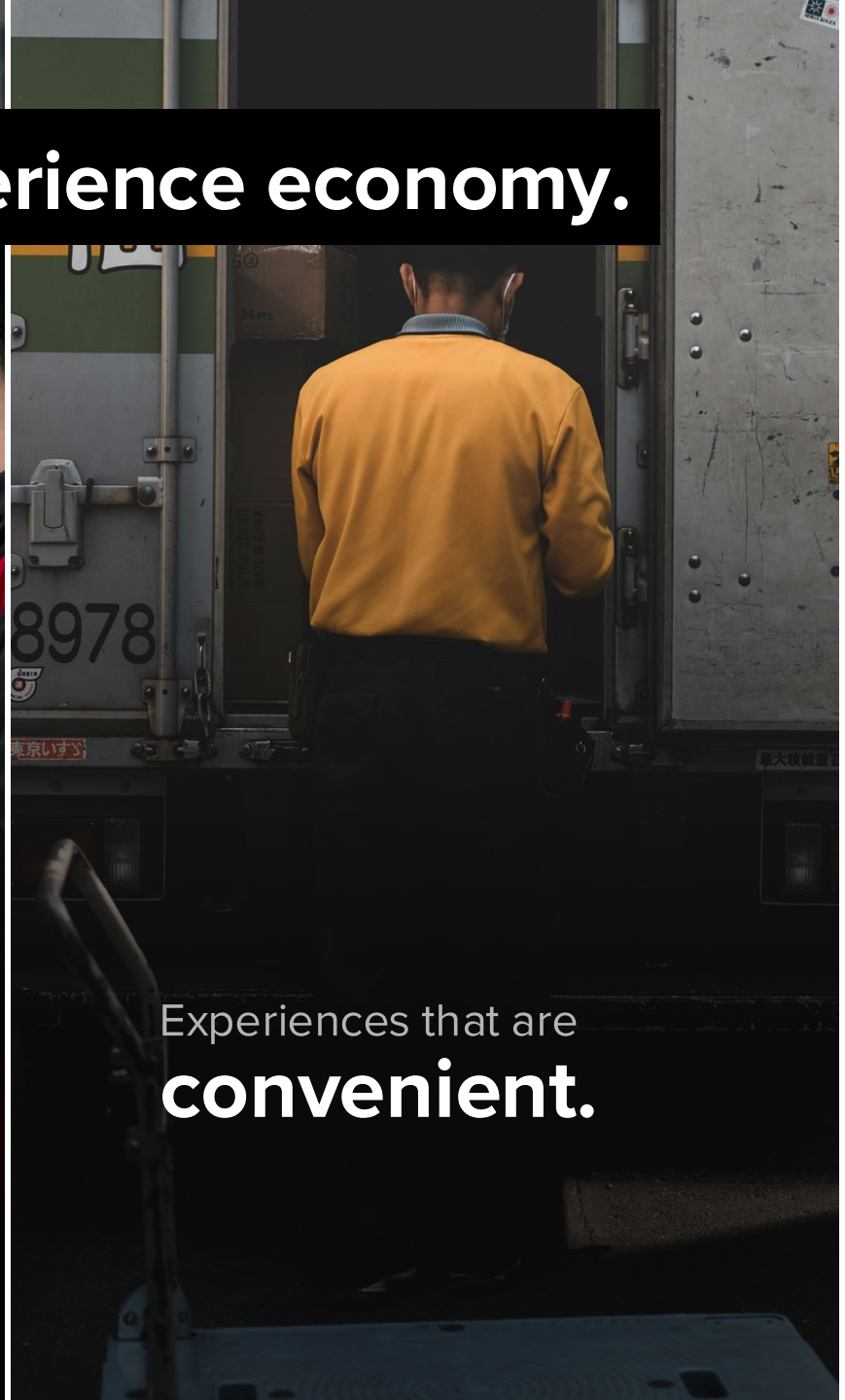
of B2B buyers think it **takes far too long** to make a purchase from their B2B suppliers

Sources: Merkle B2B Superpowers

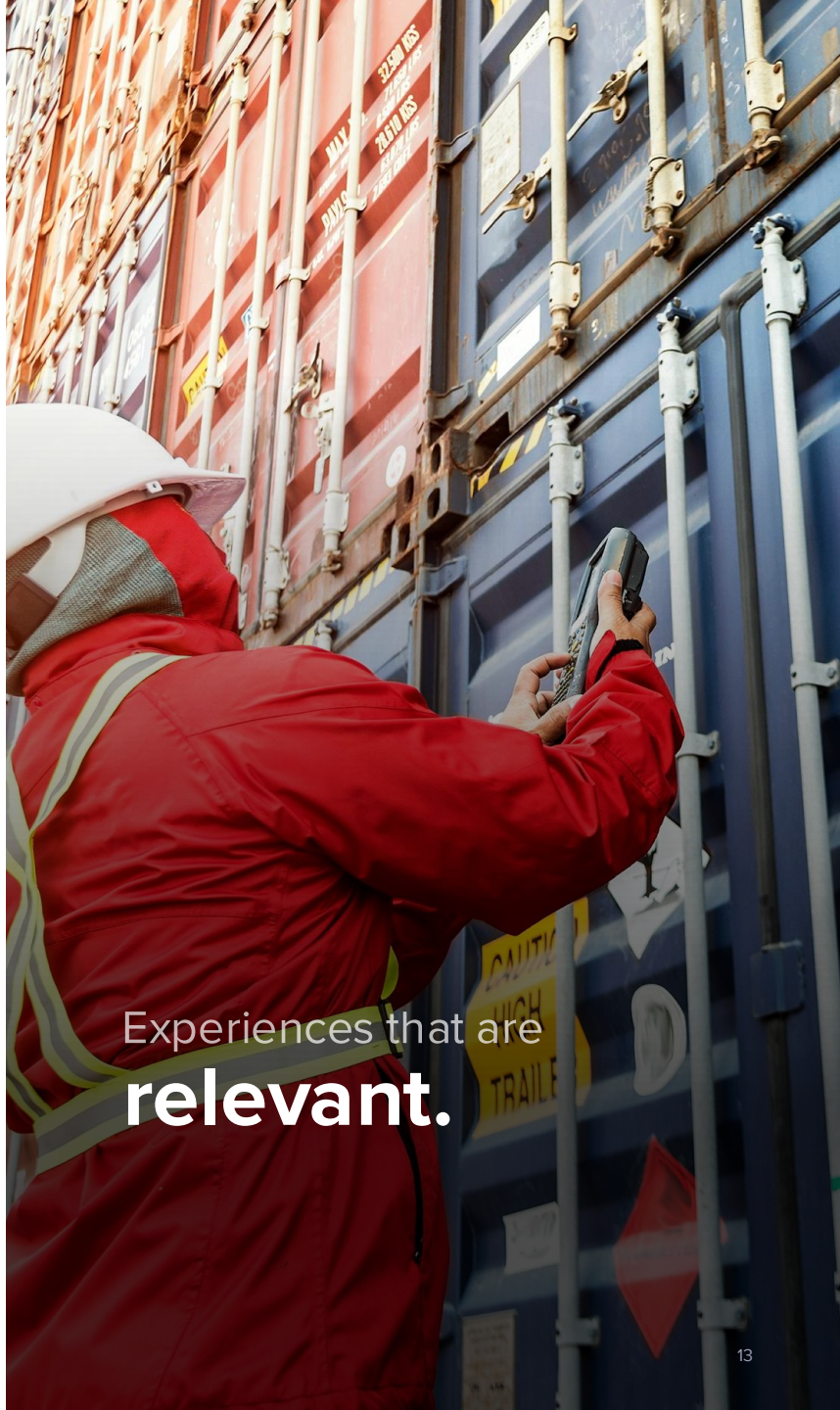
We power the experience economy.



Experiences that create
trust.



Experiences that are
convenient.



Experiences that are
relevant.

It’s not how many times
you get it right.

It’s how **few times you get it wrong**.

Maximizing value across the entire B2B lifecycle requires a different approach.

“Do I feel safe signing a contract with them?”

“Are they active thought leaders?”

“Do they support us with expertise?”

“Do they offer enough variety and choice?”

“Are they there when I need them?”

“Do they offer tools to maximize value?”

“Do they allow self-service customization?”

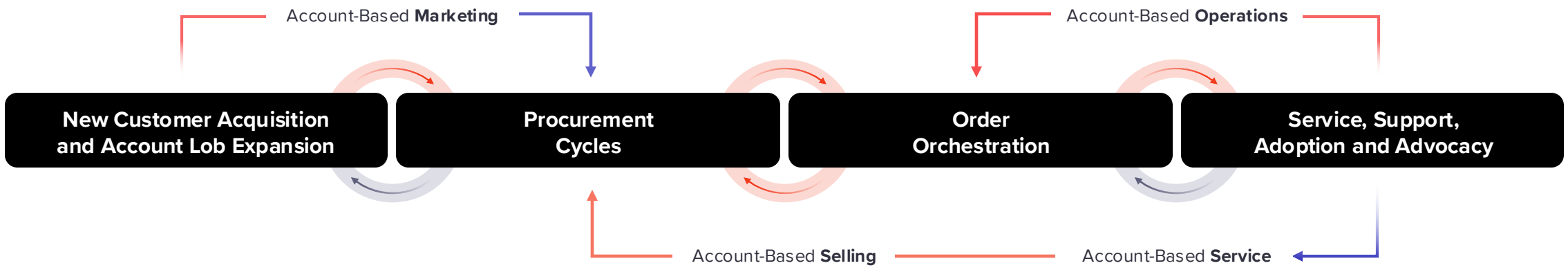
Account-based *everything.*

Transforming your B2B Customer Experience.

The need to deliver dynamic **Account-Based Experiences** is being fueled by the **Modernization of Technologies** and the prolific **Rise of Artificial Intelligence,** creating a pivot point for many B2B industries.

Digital / AI Led

Physical / Human Led



Brand Marketing and Demand Generation	Lead Capture	Lead Management and Nurture	Contract Negotiation	Deal Creation: Size / Spec / Scope	B2B Commerce	Shipment Scheduling and Re-Ordering	Account Management and Customer Advocacy	Customer Self-Serve
Awareness Campaigns	Content Marketing	Lead Qualification	Pricing and Terms	Product Specs (PIM)	Order Orchestration (OMS)	Replacement Product	Churn Mitigation	Service Agents
Paid Media	Tradeshow and Events	Lead Scoring	Contract Setup	Quote Creation (CPQ)	Shipping Schedule and Logistics	Shipping Modifications	Contract Renewals	Cross-sell / Up-sell
Owned and Earned Media	Demo / Trial	Email Nurture	Subscriptions	Inventory and Availability	Invoice and Billing	Supply Chain Mgmt.	Contract Expansion	CSR Escalations
Sponsorships	Outbound Marketing	Sales Outreach	Discounts and Rebates	Service and Warranties	Revenue Recognition	Reverse Logistics	Credits and Price Checks	Field Service

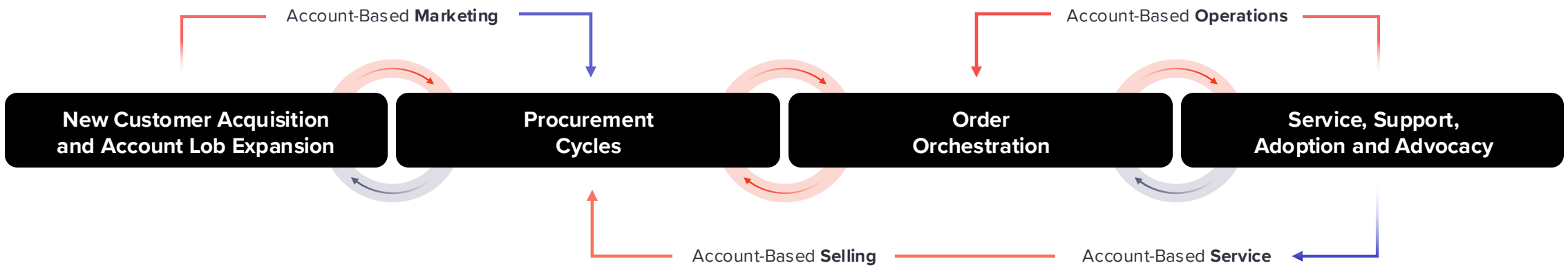
NEW CUSTOMER FOCUS

EXISTING CUSTOMER GROWTH

Driving Measurable Outcomes.

By leveraging **Account-Based Intelligence** to deliver leading **Account-Based Experiences,** B2B companies can more effectively drive **measurable outcomes across these KPIs.**

- Digital / AI Led
- Physical / Human Led



Brand Marketing and Demand Generation	Lead Capture	Lead Management and Nurture	Contract Negotiation	Deal Creation: Size / Spec / Scope	B2B Commerce	Shipment Scheduling and Re-Ordering	Account Management and Customer Advocacy	Customer Self-Serve
Share of Voice	Qualified Leads	Times to Close/ Sales Velocity	Close Rate	Share of Wallet	Profitability per Customer	Task Completion Rate		
Account Reach and Penetration	Top Line Revenue	Cost to Sell	Avg Contract Value	Purchase Frequency/ Retention	Profitability per Product Category	Call Center Reduction/Deflection		

The impact of an "account-based everything" approach

Growth

Cost Out

Share of Voice

Receive **much higher NPS scores** (+83 vs +23)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Qualified Leads

25% increase in conversion of MQL to SQL
- Gartner

Times to Close/ Sales Velocity

Average sales cycles being **27% shorter**
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Close Rate

38% higher sales win rate
- Salesforce

Share of Wallet

Almost **twice as likely to be adopted for further products and services** (41% vs 23%)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Profitability per Customer

20%+ higher ROI for "account-based" investments
- Forrester

Task Completion Rate

28% increase in engagement rates
- Gartner

Account Reach and Penetration

28% faster revenue growth
- Salesforce

Top Line Revenue

14% increase in pipeline conversion rate
- Gartner

Cost to Sell

20%+ higher ROI for "account-based" investments
- Forrester

Avg Contract Value

13% increase in average deal size
- Gartner

Purchase Frequency/ Retention

Nearly 3 times as likely to see increased spend from their customers in the future (33% vs. 13% for other brands)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

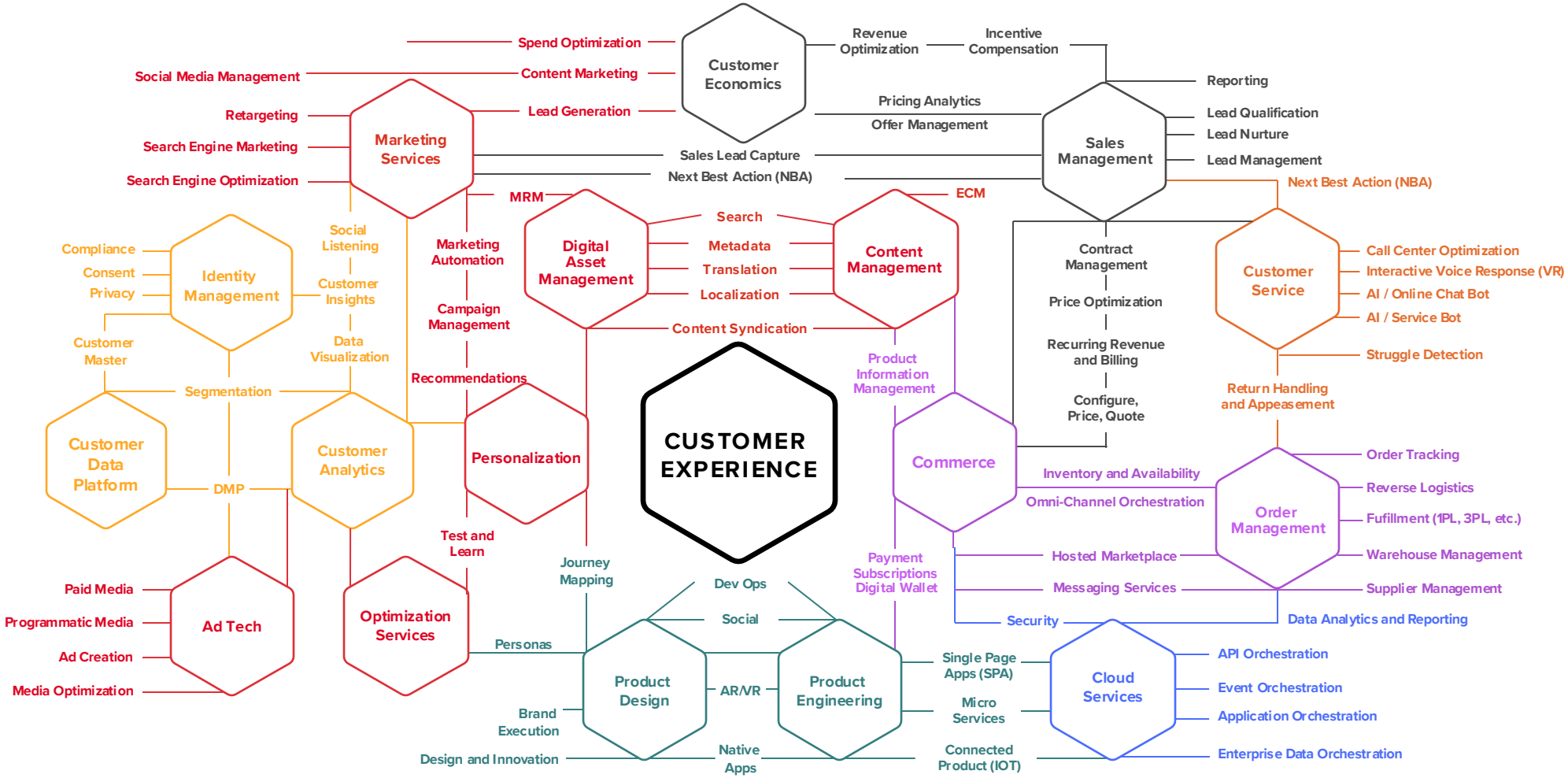
Profitability per Product Category

2.5x Brands expecting significantly higher profits in 5 years are 2.5x more likely to pursue ABM than those expecting a decline.

Call Center Reduction/ Deflection

Receive **much higher NPS scores** (+83 vs +23)
- Merkle 2024 Superpowers

Visual model of the connected digital ecosystem



ACCOUNT-BASED

Everything

Champions: CEO, Board of Directors, C-Suite

ACCOUNT-BASED

Marketing

Audience: CMO, CDO, Product Marketing, Marketing Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Selling

Audience: CRO, CDO, CIO, CFO, Sales Operations, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Service and Advocacy

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Operations and Automation

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

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Operations and Automation

Audience: COO, CFO, CDO, CIO, Customer and Field Service, Supply Chain Operations

ACCOUNT-BASED

Service and Advocacy

Account-based service and advocacy **transforms traditional service teams** into **revenue-generating growth engines** that proactively drive expansion, retention, and loyalty within strategic accounts.

Rather than simply resolving issues, these teams focus on **deepening relationships and identifying opportunities** that reduce churn while increasing account value and brand affinity.

Quality Service and Advocacy is no longer an option but the differentiator to creating customer loyalty and capturing new revenue.

- **60-70%** of B2B customers say they'd consider **switching vendors** if a better option came along
- **89%** of B2B customers have switched to a competitor after **a poor service experience**
- The Digitization of B2B driven by Alibaba has reduced costs and complexity for B2B customers to switch providers

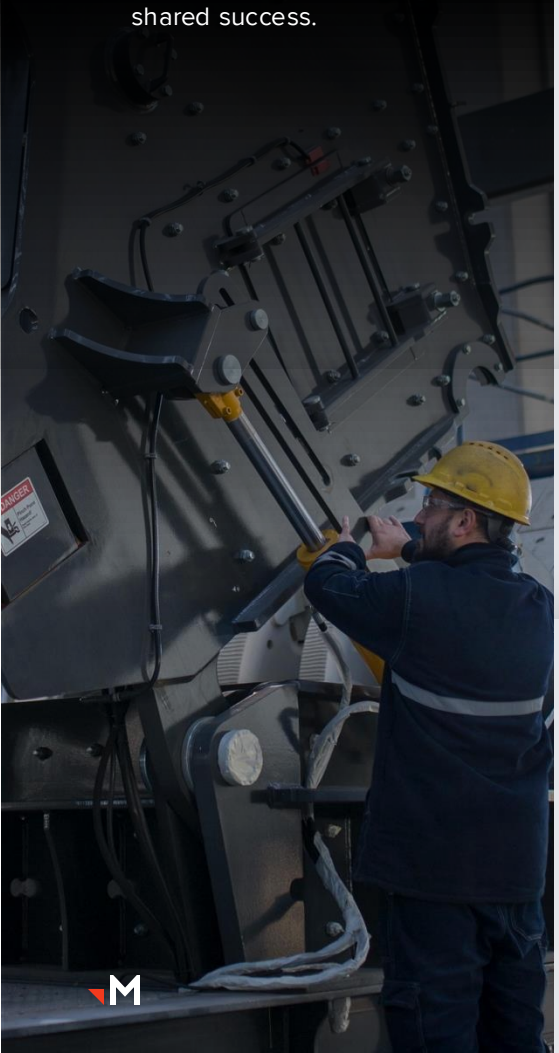
Customer Service drives revenue

Service teams become Growth teams creating new revenue, driving repeat / ongoing purchase, reduce customer churn and increase brand affinity / brand loyalty.

TRADITIONAL B2B MARKETING	ACCOUNT-BASED SERVICE AND ADVOCACY
Trusted relationships	Increase brand loyalty and openness to recommendations or upgrades
Increased AOV	Up-sell and cross-sell from value additive offerings or adjacent services
Reduced Churn	Trust and convenience makes switching harder for buyers
Data driven recommendations	Quick relevant suggestions that are easy to buy
Feedback loop	Front line feedback to product and marketing teams

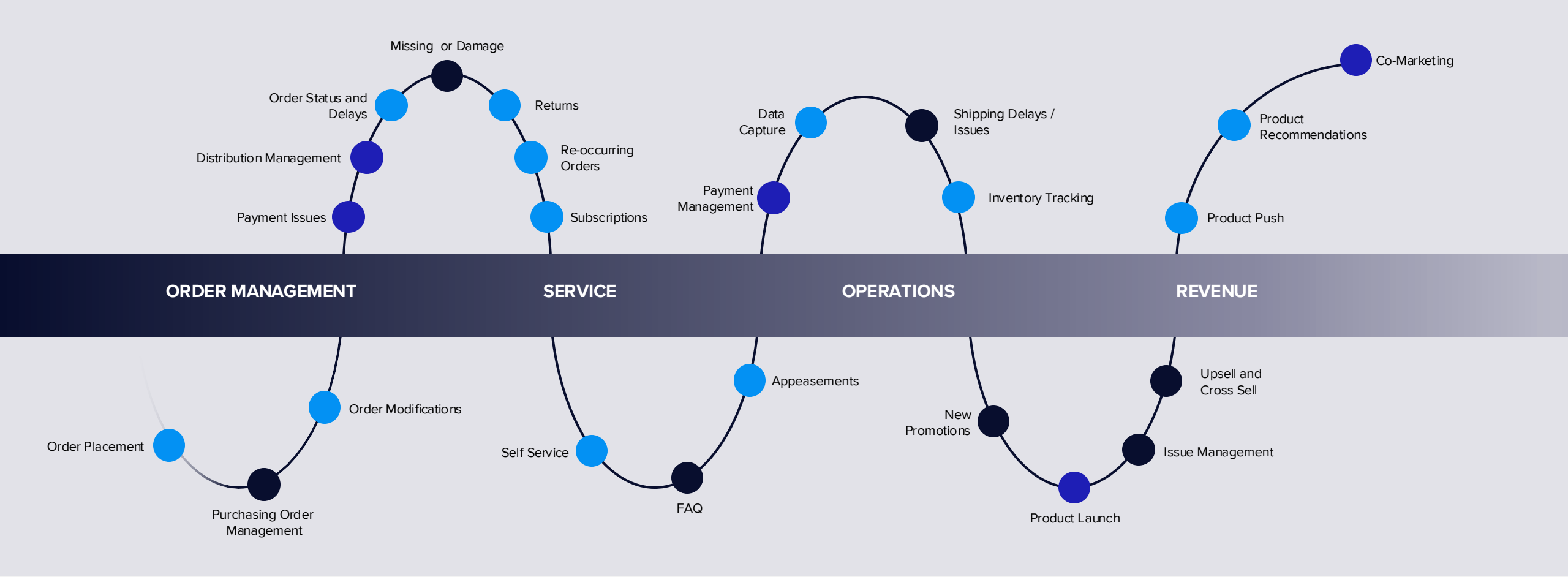
Key Sales Stakeholders

Though their motivations, and pain points vary, they must align to reach a shared success.



	Customer Service Manager	Sales / Account Team	Technical Product Leadership	CIO	Field Service
	"Our customers are our priority, and want them to feel valued in resolving their inquiries."	**"The more I research the technology, the more options I find and I really need to narrow it down."**	**"I need to ensure that any vendors we work with or products we explore will be compliant to our specifications and well received."**	**"I need consolidated single platforms and systems of record."**	**"Make my job easy by having all the information I need in one place and help me avoid delays in work completion."**
MOTIVATIONS	Address questions and concerns, find opportunities for value-add revenue	Grow revenue from existing customer base	Improving products based on customer feedback and needs	Reduce number of systems, simplify data and integrations	Complete work on time in single call, solve problems before they become issues
PAIN POINTS	TTR, CSAT, Call Volume, CS Staffing	Order transparency, issues leading to customer attrition	Understanding how customers use products, issues from product design	Total cost of ownership, FTEs to support platforms, release management	Avoidable delays, missing parts, dual data entry, information delays

The end goal: impact every touchpoint of the service journey



Human Digital Digitally Assisted

ACCOUNT BASED SERVICE
and ADVOCACY

AI Driven Service

- Case Management
- Next Best Action
- Service Agents
- Workflow Automation
- Call Deflection
- Reputation Management

Asset Management and Warranty

- Warranty Process Automation
- Asset Management

Service Modernization

- Case Management and Ticketing
- SMS
- Knowledge Management
- Service Escalation Path

Field Service

- Mobile Apps
- Order Servicing
- Scheduling and Dispatching

PART 2:

Case Studies and Why Merkle

This content provides reasons to believe that we are uniquely qualified to solve the client challenge presented in the preceding narrative.

Case studies should only be presented under NDA. If no NDA exists, the case studies should be blinded.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

Commercial transformation across sales and service

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Revamp the outdated custom-built ordering system to increase efficiencies, support commercial operations with a scalable tech architecture for growth plans.

MERKLE SOLUTION

We modernized the sales & service customer experience by creating two commerce storefront experiences – one for Allied's 500 sellers, and one for its customers. In addition, we developed a scalable tech ecosystem that provides a comprehensive view of customers, integrates with other systems and supports multi-cloud environments.

- Salesforce B2B Commerce (& Merkle's Rocket Accelerator)
- Salesforce Sales Cloud
- Salesforce Service Cloud
- MuleSoft

50%
Efficiencies gained in new customer service onboarding

300+
Sellers with transformed customer toolset

Westlake Chemical

Digitizing the order-to-delivery journey for regulated products

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Westlake Chemical, a leader in highly regulated products like chlorine, faced challenges delivering a seamless customer experience across ordering, tracking, and documentation. Customers lacked a centralized way to manage orders, rail shipments, and critical docs like COAs and invoices in real time. Each business unit also struggled to scale lead generation, product launches, and account growth due to fragmented marketing systems.

MERKLE SOLUTION

Merkle partnered with Westlake Chemical to build a secure, self-service portal that streamlines the full order lifecycle—from online purchasing to real-time tracking, across modes. Customers can access onboarding workflows, COAs, invoices, and order history instantly. Each business unit can drive leads, launch new products, and deliver ABX strategies through the portal, powered by fully integrated SF Marketing Cloud.

B2B Commerce:

- Salesforce B2B Commerce (Rocket Acceleration)
- Salesforce Sales & Service
- Salesforce B2B Lightning
- Salesforce Communities
- SAP ERP
- Salesforce Marketing Cloud Engagement

PART 3:

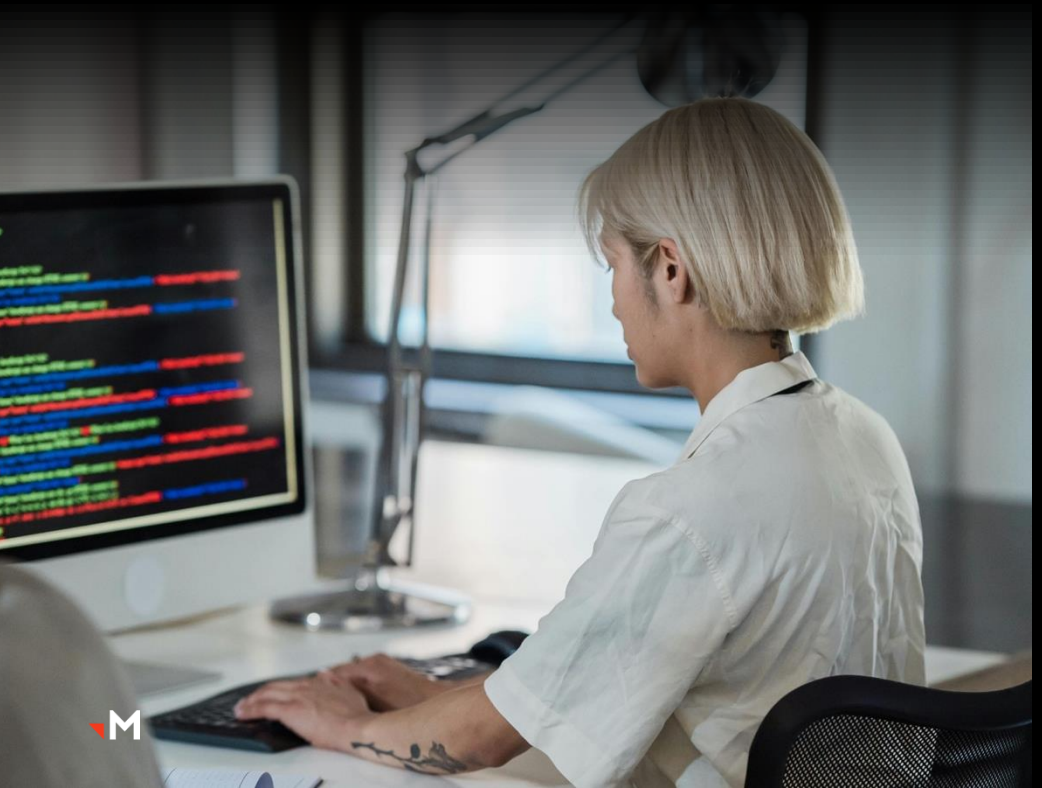
Wedges and Engagements

This content outlines the various packages you can sell within this offering. The wedges, or door openers, are priced to help get the first sale. The engagements fit various needs related to the offering. Put one or a few in front of your client, based on their needs.

These slides are ready for client or prospect presentation.

AI Driven Service

Customers want faster response times and reduced agent load. Use AI and automation to increase first-contact resolution and deflect low-value inquiries.



Our Approach

Transform your service approach with highly targeted data driven strategies.

Your Challenges

- Effective guided sales directs and supports sellers through their sales process. Businesses need to address the unique challenges to offer seamless and comprehensive experiences for their B2B clients while ensuring maximum efficiency and standards.

Our Solution

- Intelligently deployed Bots
- Next Best Action
- Auto-triage and workflows

What You Get

- Improve service efficiency (process standardization and automation)
- Improve collaboration and customer relation (remove silos and enable 360° View)
- Improve service process and drive growth (conversion rate and cross-/up-sell)

Representative Clients: Formerra

Asset Management and Warranty

Serves multiple strategic and operational purposes, especially for manufacturers, field service providers, and B2B companies.

Our Approach

Automate warranty registration, asset tracking, and entitlement management

Your Challenges

- Incomplete visibility of installed assets and ownership.
- Manual, error-prone warranty activation processes.
- Lost revenue from unregistered warranties and expired service contracts.
- Poor service delivery due to lack of asset history and entitlements.
- Inability to forecast maintenance, upgrades, or replacements.

Our Solution

- Provide real-time visibility into assets and their lifecycle.
- Automate and standardize warranty registration and entitlement.
- Improve service team efficiency and customer satisfaction.
- Create revenue through warranty renewals, upsells, and proactive service.
- Enable accurate reporting and product performance insights

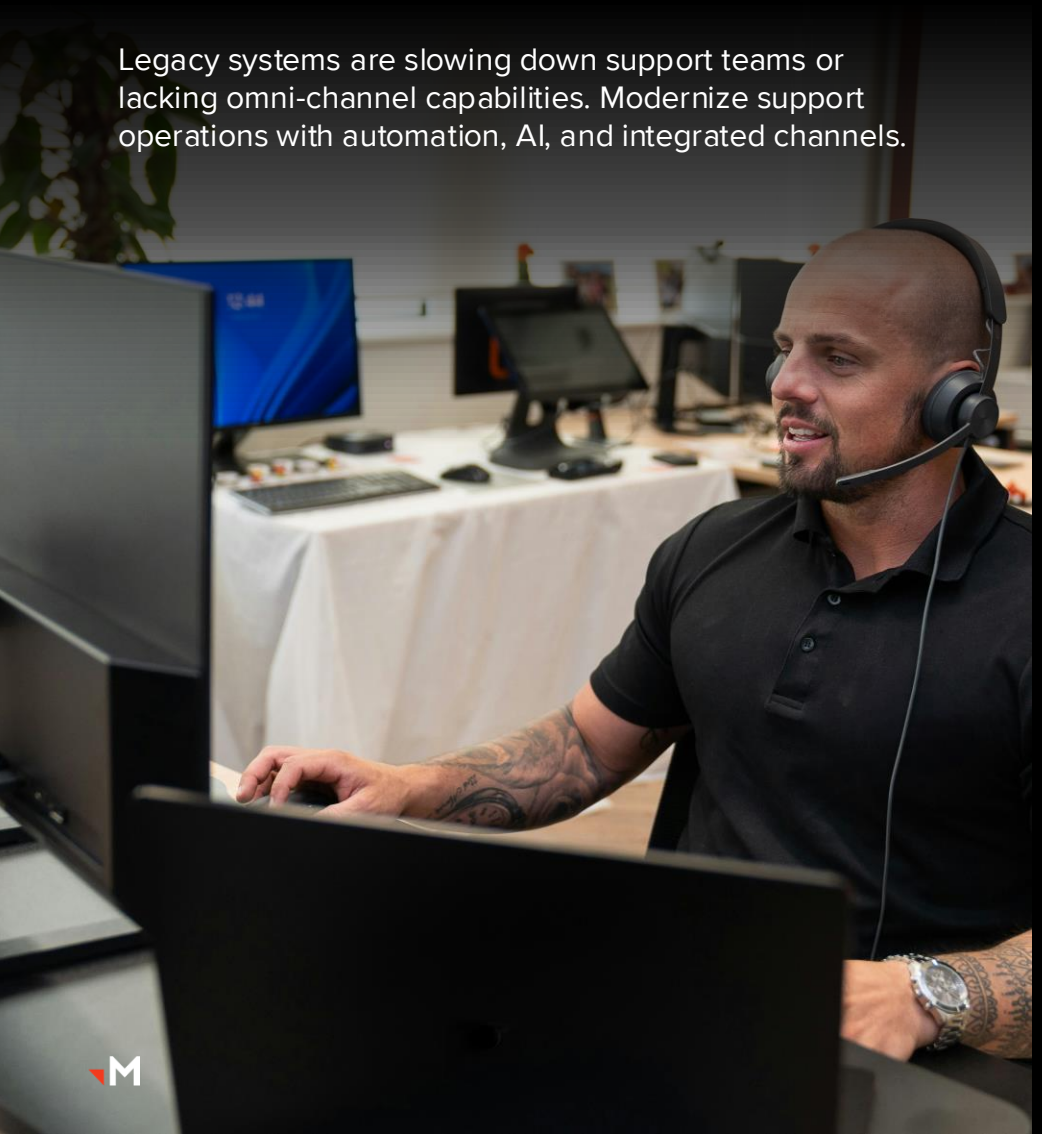
What You Get

- Operational efficiency
- Customer satisfaction
- Revenue enablement

Representative Clients: valmont

Service Modernization

Legacy systems are slowing down support teams or lacking omni-channel capabilities. Modernize support operations with automation, AI, and integrated channels.



Our Approach

Modernize B2B customer service by unifying data, teams, and channels on one platform to deliver proactive support, streamline operations, and strengthen long-term customer relationships.

Your Challenges

- Meeting rising customer expectations for fast, personalized, and consistent support while dealing with fragmented systems, outdated processes, and limited visibility across the customer lifecycle.

Our Solution

- Case management
- Omni-channel routing (chat, voice, email, social)
- Service Console
- Knowledge management

What You Get

- Decrease cost to service across sales and service (call deflection)
- Allows CSRs to focus on high value activities
- Increase average account value (cross-sell, upsell)
- Increase customer satisfaction

Representative Clients:

Highline Warren

Field Service

The customer has technicians, installers, or mobile service workers. Digitally transform field service for better efficiency, scheduling, and real-time updates to maximize relevance and results.

Our Approach

Connects your frontline teams with real-time data, intelligent scheduling, and mobile tools to deliver faster, smarter, and more personalized onsite service

Your Challenges

- Inefficient scheduling and dispatching, leading to missed appointments or underutilized resources.
- Lack of real-time visibility into technician location, job status, and inventory.
- Disconnected systems and data silos that hinder coordination between service, sales, and support teams.
- Inconsistent customer experiences due to limited communication and service delays.
- Limited mobile capabilities, slowing down onsite resolution and documentation.

Our Solution

- Mobile Field Service app
- Smart scheduling and dispatching
- Asset and parts tracking
- Offline capabilities

What You Get

- Improved efficiency and cost savings through optimized scheduling, reduced repeat visits, and streamlined operations.
- Higher customer satisfaction and loyalty by delivering fast, transparent, and reliable onsite service.
- Increased revenue opportunities via preventative maintenance, service contracts, and empowered field teams

Representative Clients: fives

PART 4:
Training

The aim of this INTERNAL ONLY section is for sales teams to learn the details of the offering, how it fits in the overall Merkle capability landscape, the various packages you can sell within this offering based on client needs, and how to sell it to clients and prospects.

Market Contacts

STEVE CONWAY

B2B Transformation Solution Lead
VP – B2B, Commerce, Marketplace Solutions

STEVE DURAN

B2B Transformation Growth Lead
VP – CX&C GTM

NICK SCHULTE

Salesforce B2B Lead
VP – Salesforce GTM

CHRIS KOSTAKIS

B2B Technology Lead
SVP – CX&C Technology

MIKE BRUNST

Executive Sales Lead
EVP – CX&C

ERIC BUSS

Executive Sponsor
EVP – CX&C

01

Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

CEO/CTO/CMO

Chief Customer Officer (CCO) / Chief Service Officer (CSO) / VP Customer Experience

Service leaders transforming customer service from cost center to revenue driver. Priorities include reducing cost-to-serve, improving first-contact resolution, and creating omnichannel experiences that drive customer retention and expansion.

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) / VP Digital Transformation

Technology executives modernizing legacy service systems, integrating AI and automation, and unifying fragmented customer data. Focused on platform consolidation, API integration, and enabling real-time visibility across the service journey.

Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) / VP Customer Success

Marketing and customer success leaders recognizing service interactions as critical revenue moments. Interested in turning service touchpoints into growth engines through data-driven recommendations and proactive engagement.

Concern #1

Service teams are overwhelmed by high call volumes and repetitive inquiries, preventing them from focusing on high-value customer interactions that drive revenue and advocacy.

Concern #2

Fragmented systems create poor customer experiences with no unified view across order management, service history, field operations, and revenue opportunities—resulting in customer frustration and churn.

Concern #3

Legacy service operations lack AI-driven automation and intelligent workflows, causing slow response times, inconsistent service delivery, and missed opportunities to convert service interactions into revenue.

PRIMARY OUTCOMES

Outcome	Why it Matters
Service-to-Revenue Transformation	Convert service interactions into revenue opportunities through intelligent upselling, cross-selling, and proactive customer expansion strategies that increase account value by 25-40%. Service teams become growth engines rather than cost centers, directly contributing to topline revenue.
Operational Excellence	AI-driven case management, automated warranty processing, and optimized field service operations reduce resolution time by 35% while improving first-call resolution rates. Automation deflects 40-60% of routine inquiries, freeing agents for high-value activities and reducing cost-to-serve by 30-50%.
Customer Advocacy and Retention	Proactive service delivery, personalized customer experiences, and intelligent churn prevention increase customer lifetime value and Net Promoter Scores. Seamless omnichannel experiences and predictive service interventions improve retention by 15-25%, protecting revenue base and reducing costly customer acquisition.
Strategic Account Growth	Data-driven insights and predictive analytics enable account managers to identify expansion opportunities across the entire service journey. Unified customer view connects order history, service interactions, asset data, and usage patterns—revealing white space for cross-sell and upsell that strengthens customer relationships and increases wallet share.

10

Buyers and Industries

Understand our buyer and their motivation as well as the outcomes we deliver that help them meet their goals. Dive into industry-specific considerations.

TARGET INDUSTRIES

Describe specific industries or verticals where this offering is particularly relevant.

Industry	Why it Matters	Do we have vertical-specific content?
Manufacturing & Industrial Equipment	Complex products require extensive field service, warranty management, and asset tracking. Service contracts and preventative maintenance represent significant recurring revenue opportunities. AI-driven service transforms technician efficiency, reduces downtime for customers, and enables predictive maintenance that drives account expansion.	Valmont, Formerra
Healthcare & Medical Devices	Regulatory compliance, asset tracking, and uptime criticality make warranty management and field service optimization essential. Service teams must balance efficiency with patient safety and quality standards. Predictive maintenance and automated case routing reduce response times while maintaining documentation requirements.	Cardinal Health
Building Materials & Construction Equipment	Distributed dealer networks and field service technicians require mobile tools, real-time parts tracking, and intelligent scheduling. Equipment downtime directly impacts customer revenue, making fast resolution and proactive service critical differentiators. Service data reveals usage patterns for targeted upsell of attachments, parts, and service contracts.	Builder's First Choice
Business Services & Distribution	Multi-location operations and complex service delivery models need unified platforms connecting sales, service, and operations teams. High customer acquisition costs make retention and account expansion through service excellence critical to profitability. AI-driven recommendations enable service teams to identify cross-sell opportunities and strengthen customer relationships.	Highline Warren, Lincoln Electric

PART 4: TRAINING

B2B Transformation: Account-based Service and Advocacy

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Commercial Guidance

Guidance on price point, market size, and competitive landscape for an offering in a given market.

Client-facing pricing slides for each engagement can be found on slides in the what we sell section of this toolkit.

Key competitors	**Name:** McKinsey & Company / Boston Consulting Group (BCG) **Description:** Top-tier strategy consultancies providing B2B transformation vision and business case development. Strong C-suite relationships but typically hand off implementation. **Merkle Differentiation:** End-to-end execution from strategy through platform deployment and ongoing optimization	**Name:** Accenture Interactive (Accenture Song) **Description:** Largest digital consultancy with massive scale and global delivery. Competes on enterprise B2B transformations for Fortune 500. **Merkle Differentiation:** More agile engagement models, deeper commerce specialization, integrated marketing/commerce vs. siloed practices
	Name: PwC Digital / EY Consulting / KPMG Advisory **Description:** Big Four expanding into digital transformation and commerce. Strong in enterprise architecture and compliance, less differentiated in CX design and marketing technology. **Merkle Differentiation:** Superior experience design and integrated marketing/commerce capabilities	**Name:** Deloitte Digital / Cognizant / Infosys / Wipro / TCS **Description:** Large-scale system integrators competing on complex, multi-year implementations. Cost-competitive but less emphasis on customer experience. **Merkle Differentiation:** Experience-led transformation and measurement/optimization post-launch vs. technical delivery focus
	Name: Bain & Company **Description:** Strategy consultancy with strong PE relationships and results-oriented B2B transformation approach. Limited hands-on commerce platform implementation. **Merkle Differentiation:** Full-service capability combining strategic vision with technical execution	
Key Alliances	**Adobe | Salesforce | Mirakl | commercetools | SAP | Oracle | VTEX | Shopify Plus** Merkle maintains premier/platinum partnerships with leading commerce and marketplace platforms, providing co-innovation opportunities, preferential pricing, and joint go-to-market initiatives. Unlike competitors tied to single platforms, Merkle's vendor-agnostic approach enables objective technology selection—then leverages deep platform expertise to accelerate implementation and reduce risk.	

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Why Merkle

Merkle is uniquely positioned to help our clients thrive and win in the current landscape. Understand how the Merkle story resonates in this context and grab relevant case studies.

OUR STORY: KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

Merkle transforms customer service from cost center to revenue driver through comprehensive Account-based service and Advocacy capabilities that competitors can't match.

What Sets Us Apart:

Service-to-Revenue Expertise: Proven methodology converting service interactions into growth opportunities through intelligent upselling, cross-selling, and proactive expansion strategies. Our clients achieve 25-40% account value increases by making service teams revenue engines.

End-to-End Service Transformation: Unlike point solution providers, we address the entire service journey—from AI-driven case management and warranty automation to field service optimization and asset management—creating unified customer experiences that drive loyalty and retention.

AI and Automation at Scale: Proprietary AI models and automation frameworks reduce resolution time by 35%, deflect 40-60% of routine inquiries, and enable predictive service interventions. Our intelligent workflows free agents to focus on high-value customer interactions.

Data-Driven Customer Intelligence: Unified customer view connecting order history, service interactions, asset data, and usage patterns reveals white space for expansion. Predictive analytics identify churn risk and opportunity, enabling proactive account management.

Industry-Specialized Solutions: Deep expertise in manufacturing, technology, healthcare, building materials, and business services with proven frameworks for field service, warranty management, and complex service delivery models.

OUR WORK

Client	Project	Market	Description	Link to case
Formerra	AI-Driven Service	Industrial Manufacturing	Intelligent case routing and automated triage reduced first-contact resolution time by 40% while identifying cross-sell opportunities.	LINK
Valmont	Asset Management & Warranty	Agriculture Equipment / Infrastructure	Automated warranty registration and asset tracking enabled predictive maintenance programs driving recurring revenue.	LINK
Highline Warren	Service Modernization	Business Services / Distribution	Unified omnichannel platform reduced cost-to-serve by 35% while improving customer experience.	LINK

MARKET VALIDATION

Analyst	Report Name	Ranking Name	Year
Forrester	The Forrester Wave™: B2B Commerce Suites	Merkle (Dentsu) recognized as Strong Performer in B2B Commerce Services	2024
Gartner	Magic Quadrant for Digital Commerce	Merkle recognized for B2B Commerce Implementation Services	2024
IDC	IDC MarketScape: Worldwide Digital Commerce Services	Named as Major Player in Digital Commerce Consulting and Implementation	2024

04

Sales Guidance

Help selling through the offering, from handling objections to understanding similar/competitive offerings where they exist.

GUIDANCE AND GUIDELINES

Positioning the Offering

Transform service from cost center to revenue engine through AI-powered customer success platforms

Frame as competitive imperative: B2B buyers expect consumer-grade service experiences

Unified platform connecting case management, field service, asset tracking, and warranty vs. fragmented point solutions

Key Messaging Points

Service teams become growth teams: AI turns interactions into revenue moments (25-40% account value increase)

End-to-end transformation from strategy through optimization, unlike pure tech vendors or consultancies

AI deflects 40-60% of routine work, freeing agents for high-value activities

Proven ROI in 6-9 months with entry points under $100K

Common Objections & Responses

"We already have Salesforce/ServiceNow" → We enhance platforms with AI intelligence and industry workflows, not replace them

"Service is a cost center" → Our clients convert 25-40% more interactions into revenue through intelligent recommendations

"Sounds expensive and long" → High-impact use cases deliver ROI in 6-9 months. Entry under $100K proves value first

WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

- Service costs increasing but CSAT decreasing ***--> AI driven service***
- Losing customers due to competitors with better service ***--> Service modernization***
- Field technicians spend a lot of time scheduling and don't have data access - ***--> Field service***
- Don't know warranty and service contract dates ***--> customer 360***
- Lack of self-service capabilities ***--> Case deflection and self service***
- Can't forecast demand and prevent churn ***--> Predictive analytics***

QUALIFYING QUESTIONS

- Walk me through what happens when a customer contacts service today—how many systems do agents touch, and where do requests typically get stuck?
- What visibility do you have into your installed asset base, warranty status, and service contract performance across your customer portfolio?
- How confident are you in your ability to predict service demand, identify at-risk customers, and prevent churn before it happens?
- What percentage of service inquiries could be resolved through self-service if customers had the right tools and information?
- If you could transform one aspect of your service operations that would fundamentally improve both customer satisfaction and revenue growth, what would it be?
- How do your field service technicians currently access customer history, product information, parts inventory, and scheduling—and what friction exists in those workflows?

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: Account-based SERVICE AND Advocacy

AI-Driven Service

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

B2B service organizations face overwhelming call volumes and repetitive inquiries that prevent agents from focusing on high-value customer interactions driving revenue and advocacy. Fragmented systems create poor customer experiences with no unified view across channels, causing frustration and inefficiency. Legacy processes lack AI-driven automation and intelligent workflows, resulting in slow response times, inconsistent service delivery, and missed opportunities to convert service interactions into revenue moments.

OBJECTIVE

Deploy AI-powered service platform that transforms traditional reactive support into proactive, revenue-generating customer success operations. Implement intelligent case management with automated triage, next-best-action recommendations, and chatbot deflection to handle routine inquiries while routing complex issues to specialized agents. Enable service teams to focus on relationship building, upselling, and cross-selling through unified customer intelligence and automated workflows that improve efficiency and customer satisfaction.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Service Modernization: Expand to comprehensive omnichannel platform with unified case management and self-service portal

Advanced Analytics & Predictive Intelligence: Deploy churn prediction models, sentiment analysis, and proactive outreach automation

Knowledge Management & AI Chatbots: Build intelligent knowledge base with conversational AI for 24/7 customer support

Customer Success Platform Integration: Connect service data to account management for revenue expansion strategies

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Formerra

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Assess current service operations, pain points, call volume patterns, and identify high-impact automation opportunities

Design: Configure AI models for case classification, intelligent routing rules, next-best-action logic, and chatbot conversation flows

Build: Implement AI-driven service platform with automated triage, predictive routing, agent assist tools, and customer self-service capabilities

Testing: Validate AI accuracy, routing logic, and workflows through pilot programs with select service teams and customer segments

Training: Enable service agents on AI-assisted tools, next-best-action recommendations, and new workflows for revenue identification

Rollout: Phased deployment with continuous model refinement based on customer feedback and agent performance metrics

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

AI-Powered Case Management: Intelligent case classification, automated triage, and predictive routing reducing manual work by 40-60%

Next-Best-Action Engine: Real-time recommendations guiding agents to optimal responses, upsell opportunities, and proactive outreach

Customer Intelligence Platform: Unified 360° view connecting service history, account data, and behavioral insights for personalized engagement

Chatbot & Self-Service Frameworks: Conversational AI templates for common B2B service scenarios with seamless handoff to agents

Service-to-Revenue Playbooks: Proven methodologies for identifying expansion opportunities during service interactions

Investment: $150-400K

Timing: 12-16 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Improve service efficiency by 40-60%** through AI-powered case deflection and automated triage, reducing agent workload and enabling focus on complex, high-value interactions
- **Improve collaboration and customer relations** by removing silos with 360° customer view, enabling seamless handoffs between service, sales, and account teams
- **Improve service process and drive growth** by increasing conversion rates on cross-sell/upsell recommendations by 25-35% through intelligent next-best-action guidance
- **Reduce customer churn by 15-25%** through proactive service delivery, faster resolution times, and personalized experiences that increase satisfaction and loyalty

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: Account-based SERVICE AND Advocacy

Asset Management and Warranty

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Manufacturers lack complete visibility of installed assets and ownership, making proactive service impossible. Manual warranty activation causes customer frustration and revenue leakage from unregistered warranties and expired contracts. Inadequate asset history prevents effective service delivery while inability to forecast maintenance creates missed revenue opportunities.

OBJECTIVE

Deploy asset management and warranty automation platform providing real-time visibility into installed base, lifecycle status, and entitlements. Automate warranty registration and service contract management to eliminate manual processes and revenue leakage. Enable predictive maintenance and data-driven insights that improve satisfaction while creating recurring revenue through renewals and preventative programs..

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Predictive Maintenance Programs: IoT integration and ML models forecasting failures and automating service scheduling

Service Contract Optimization: Dynamic pricing and renewal automation based on asset performance

Product Performance Analytics: Reporting on asset reliability and warranty trends informing product development

Field Service Integration: Connect asset data to technician mobile apps for complete service history

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Valmont

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Audit asset tracking, warranty processes, and identify data quality issues and revenue leakage

Design: Architect system with automated registration, entitlement rules, lifecycle tracking, and reporting

Build: Implement platform with real-time visibility, automated warranty processing, and customer portal

Testing: Validate tracking accuracy and automation rules through pilot programs

Training: Enable teams and customers on registration, claims, and self-service capabilities

Rollout: Phased deployment with data migration and continuous refinement

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

Asset Lifecycle Management Platform: Real-time visibility with automated tracking from purchase through end-of-life

Warranty Automation Engine: Intelligent registration and claim processing reducing manual work by 70-80%

Service Contract Intelligence: Automated renewal workflows and proactive outreach for expiring contracts

Predictive Analytics Models: ML forecasting maintenance needs and revenue opportunities

Customer Asset Portal: Self-service for warranty registration, claim status, and service history

Investment: $200-600K

Timing: 14-22 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Achieve operational efficiency** by reducing manual warranty processing by 70-80% and automating contract renewals
- **Improve customer satisfaction** through faster claim resolution and proactive service notifications
- **Enable revenue growth** by capturing unregistered warranties worth 15-25% of potential service revenue and identifying upsell opportunities
- **Provide product performance insights** through warranty claim analysis and failure pattern identification

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: Account-based SERVICE AND Advocacy

Service Modernization

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Legacy systems and fragmented tools slow down support teams and prevent omnichannel capabilities. Organizations struggle to meet rising customer expectations for fast, personalized, and consistent support while dealing with outdated processes and limited visibility across the customer lifecycle. Disconnected data silos hinder coordination between service, sales, and support teams, creating poor customer experiences and operational inefficiencies.

OBJECTIVE

Modernize B2B customer service by unifying data, teams, and channels on one platform to deliver proactive support, streamline operations, and strengthen long-term customer relationships. Deploy comprehensive service platform with case management, omnichannel routing (chat, voice, email, social), service console, and knowledge management. Enable seamless customer experiences across all touchpoints while providing service teams with unified customer intelligence and automated workflows.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

Advanced Self-Service Portal: Customer-facing portal with order tracking, documentation, case submission, and account management

AI-Powered Knowledge Management: Intelligent knowledge base with automated article suggestions and conversational search

Service Analytics & Reporting: Executive dashboards tracking resolution times, customer satisfaction, and service-to-revenue metrics

Integration with Commerce & Sales: Connect service data to commerce platforms and CRM for seamless account management

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Highline Warren

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Map current service touchpoints, assess legacy systems, and identify integration requirements and customer experience gaps

Design: Architect unified service platform with case management workflows, omnichannel routing rules, knowledge structure, and service console

Build: Implement modern service platform with integrated channels, unified customer view, automation rules, and agent workspace

Testing: Validate omnichannel routing, case workflows, and integrations with pilot groups across service channels

Training: Enable service teams on unified platform, new workflows, and knowledge management best practices

Rollout: Phased channel migration with change management, continuous optimization, and agent adoption tracking

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

Omnichannel Service Platform: Unified case management across chat, voice, email, and social with intelligent routing

Service Console Framework: 360° customer view with embedded tools, case history, and contextual recommendations

Knowledge Management Architecture: Structured knowledge base with search optimization and self-service capabilities

Service Modernization Roadmap: Proven methodology for migrating from legacy systems to modern service platforms

Change Management Toolkit: Adoption frameworks ensuring service team proficiency and customer transition success

Investment: $300-750K

Timing: 18-28 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Decrease cost-to-serve by 30-50%** through channel deflection, self-service adoption, and call avoidance via chat and knowledge base
- **Allow agents to focus on high-value activities** by automating routine inquiries and providing unified tools that eliminate system switching
- **Increase average account value** through improved cross-sell and upsell capabilities enabled by unified customer intelligence and service-to-sales collaboration
- **Increase customer satisfaction** with consistent omnichannel experiences, faster resolution times, and proactive communication across touchpoints

YOUR 1-PAGE SUMMARY

B2B TRANSFORMATION: Account-based SERVICE AND Advocacy

Field Service

BUSINESS CHALLENGES

Inefficient scheduling and dispatching lead to missed appointments and underutilized technician resources. Lack of real-time visibility into technician location, job status, and inventory prevents effective coordination. Disconnected systems hinder collaboration between service, sales, and support teams while limited mobile capabilities slow onsite resolution and documentation.

OBJECTIVE

Transform field service by connecting frontline teams with real-time data, intelligent scheduling, and mobile tools for faster, smarter onsite service. Deploy field service management platform with AI-powered scheduling, mobile app with offline capabilities, asset and parts tracking, and customer communication tools. Enable operational efficiency while improving satisfaction and creating revenue through preventative maintenance.

FOLLOW-ON ENGAGEMENTS

IoT & Remote Diagnostics: Connected equipment monitoring enabling predictive service and remote resolution

Advanced Scheduling Optimization: AI-driven dynamic scheduling based on skills, location, and parts availability

Contractor & Partner Management: Extended workforce management for third-party technicians

Mobile Service Portal: Customer app for appointment scheduling and technician tracking

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Fives

APPROACH AND DELIVERABLES

Discovery: Assess scheduling processes, technician workflows, and integration requirements with inventory and asset systems

Design: Configure platform with intelligent dispatch rules, mobile workflows, parts tracking, and communication templates

Build: Implement FSM with scheduling optimization, mobile tools, GPS tracking, and offline capabilities

Testing: Validate scheduling logic and mobile functionality through pilot programs with select technician teams

Training: Enable dispatchers on scheduling tools and technicians on mobile apps

Rollout: Phased regional deployment with continuous optimization of routing algorithms

MERKLE PRODUCTS AND IP

Intelligent Scheduling & Dispatch: AI-powered optimization matching technicians to jobs based on skills, proximity, and availability

Mobile Field Service App: Technician workspace with work orders, customer history, parts inventory, and offline mode

Asset & Parts Integration: Real-time visibility connecting field operations to asset management and inventory systems

Customer Communication Framework: Automated notifications for appointment confirmation and service completion

Field Service Analytics: Performance dashboards tracking first-time fix rates, travel time, and utilization

Investment: $250-700k

Timing: 16-24 weeks

Outcomes:

- **Improved efficiency and cost savings** through optimized scheduling reducing repeat visits by 30-40% and minimizing travel time
- **Higher customer satisfaction** by delivering fast, transparent onsite service with real-time tracking and proactive communication
- **Increased revenue opportunities** via preventative maintenance programs and empowered field teams identifying customer needs
- **Enhanced technician productivity** with mobile tools enabling complete work on first visit and improving documentation

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